

Search for killer resumes as victims mourned

Event intended as celebration becomes a gathering of grief

By Claire Thornton and Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF
and Emily Spatz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

PROVIDENCE — Planned celebrations marking the first night of Hanukkah and the upcoming holidays were abruptly turned into community memorials Sunday evening after a mass shooting at Brown University.

Flurries dusted Lippitt Memorial Park in Providence at about 5 p.m. Sunday as hundreds gathered for what was supposed to be a Christmas tree and menorah lighting ceremony. Instead, local leaders and neighbors passed around candles as they mourned the victims and came together for support.

“We are gathered here to share light with one another in one of Providence’s darkest times,” said Providence City Councilor Sue AnderBois, who planned the holiday celebration before the shooting.

VIGIL, Page A7



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Students hugged and held candles at a vigil Sunday evening at Lippitt Memorial Park in Providence. The gathering was held to offer support and mourn the victims of the mass shooting at Brown University.

Police to free detained man, insist community is safe

By Samantha J. Gross and Edward Fitzpatrick
GLOBE STAFF
and Ethan Schenker
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

PROVIDENCE — A suspect in the mass shooting on the Brown University campus on Saturday afternoon remained at large after authorities announced they will be releasing a person of interest who had been detained.

The gunman killed two students and injured nine others after entering a campus building, police said.

At a Sunday night press conference, officials provided few details about the person released and acknowledged the shooter is still on the run.

“We know this will likely cause fresh anxiety for our community,” said Providence Mayor Brett Smiley, adding that the Brown campus and surrounding neighborhoods remain safe.

BROWN, Page A7

Inflammation linked to cases of long COVID

Study points to possible treatment in existing drugs

By Katie Muchnick
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Five years after the start of the pandemic, a group of researchers from Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center is one step closer to identifying the cause of the mysterious and debilitating chronic condition known as long COVID — and finding a treatment.

Chronic inflammation is a key contributor to long COVID, according to a paper published in Nature Immunology on Friday. This hypothesis for the cause of long COVID is different from the prevailing hypothesis that the disease is associated with reservoirs of the virus that remain hidden in the bodies of patients long after their acute COVID infections have passed.

“It’s possible they’re both correct,” said Dr. Dan Barouch, an author of the study and director of the Center for Virology and Vaccine Research at Beth Israel Deaconess.

But what excites Barouch about the chronic inflammation hypothesis is that several anti-inflammatory drugs exist. Based on the study’s data, Barouch said Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center has started a clinical trial with one such drug — abrocitinib, which is used to treat eczema.

The viral remnant hypothesis emerged over the last several years because researchers found small viral fragments in people with long COVID.

“That was an attractive hypothesis because we have antivirals,” Barouch said. “The problem is that so far, the first three studies that have been published with Paxlovid [an antiviral used to treat COVID-19] that I’m aware of showed no therapeutic efficacy.”

Data from the National Health Interview Survey in 2023 estimated that 3.6 percent of Americans were suffering from long COVID at the time, compared with 8.4 percent who ever had long COVID. The chronic condition is highly varied, characterized by symptoms that can include extreme exhaustion, difficulty breathing, neurological problems, chronic pain, and brain fog.

COVID, Page A10



PHOTO ILLUSTRATION BY RYAN HUDDLE/GLOBE STAFF; PHOTO BY MATTHEW J LEE/GLOBE STAFF

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‘I sometimes wake up in tears for friends still there’

Tufts grad student Rümeysa Öztürk was detained in Louisiana for six weeks. It was a test for her — and the values of this country.

BY GIULIA MCDONNELL NIETO DEL RIO
AND MARK ARSENAULT | GLOBE STAFF

911 operator, March 25: “Somerville 911, this line’s being recorded.”

Caller: “Hi. Um. I just watched a woman while resisting get pushed into the back of a car.”

Operator: “Where?”

Caller: “I’m in Somerville, Massachusetts, just next to the Tufts campus ... These, like, three guys popped out and grabbed her and pushed her into a car.”

Operator: “Did you get a description on the males?”

Caller: “They had masks covering their faces.”

ÖZTÜRK, Page A4

Massacre on Aussie beach

A father and son opened fire on a Hanukkah celebration in Sydney, killing at least 15 and injuring dozens. **A3.**

A majority of high school principals nationwide reported that immigration enforcement caused students to miss school in 2025, according to a survey. **B1.**

Vendors are paying a premium for tiny spots at Snowport in the Seaport, but they say it’s worth it. **D1.**

Flip the script

Monday: Clouds emerge late. High 25-30, low 21-26.

Tuesday: Clouds break late. High 31-36, low 25-30.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **B6.**

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SNOWY MELTDOWN



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

New England Patriots head coach Mike Vrabel expressed his anger at a call during the fourth quarter in Foxborough Sunday. The Patriots surrendered a 21-point lead, falling to division rival Buffalo Bills, 35-31. **C1.**